

20-Minute Exerciser: *Victory*

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Goal: Analyse how guilt, poverty, pain, and religion are presented in the poem.

Time: 20 minutes

1. Quick start (3 min)

Write 3–4 lines:

- 5 a) What is the speaker's situation in the poem?
- b) Why does the title *Victory* seem surprising after a first reading?

2. Close reading (6 min)

Answer briefly in full sentences.

- a) What does the stolen pair of basketball shoes represent for the speaker?
- 10 b) Look at the repetition in "guilt, guilt, guilt". What effect does this have?
- c) Explain the effect of the exclamations: "O, immoral shoes!" and "O, torn skin! O, bloody heels and toes!"
- d) Find one example of imagery connected to pain. What does it add to the poem?

3. Deeper interpretation (7 min)

- 15 Choose two of the following and answer in 4–6 lines each.

- a) How is poverty shown as more than just a lack of money?
- b) What kind of father is presented in the final part of the poem?
- c) Why does the poem mix religious language with basketball language?
- d) In what sense can the ending be read as a *victory*?

20 **4. Exit ticket (4 min)**

Write one short analytical paragraph (6–8 lines):

“In *Victory*, Sherman Alexie shows that true victory is not about winning in sport, but about _____ . He presents this through _____ and _____ .”

- 25 Challenge if you finish early: Find one contrast in the poem (for example hope/pain, guilt/forgiveness, sport/religion) and explain how it shapes the message.